

KIT 6 OF 20 · 45–60 MINUTES · WHOLE STAFF · RUN KITS 1 AND 2 FIRST

AI for Communication: The message before the message

Everything you need before you present. Read this once (about 8 minutes), run the 15-minute prep checklist, and you're ready.

What this session is

This session takes one contrarian position and builds the whole hour on it: **AI's real value in family communication is not writing your hard message. It is making the ordinary, specific, positive contact happen at a volume nobody sustains by hand.** That volume is what buys a teacher credibility before they need it. The hard message they still write themselves. Everything else on the market automates the difficult conversation; we automate the easy volume and protect the difficult one on purpose.

The 20-minute lab produces two things, both real: **four positive notes written to four actual families on the teacher's roster, each carrying one true specific detail from this week, ready to send; and one hard message drafted in the teacher's own words.**

THE STANCE: REPEAT IT UNTIL IT'S FURNITURE

AI handles the ordinary contact. You still write the hard message. AI drafts, the teacher decides.

The one thing that makes or breaks this session

Slide 2 is a silent sixty-second audit, and it happens before you teach anything. Staff pick one student (ideally one they find difficult) and find the date that family last heard from them when nothing was wrong. Nobody shares. Nobody presents. You stop talking and let the room sit in it.

Practice waiting. Sixty seconds of silence feels like four minutes from the front of a room, and the reflex is to fill it with a joke or a caveat. Do not. The silence is the argument, and it is the reason this hour lands differently from every other communication PD staff have sat through. Start your watch, look at the back wall, and wait. When it ends, do not ask anyone to share. Go straight to slide 3.

Who should present it

Same bar as Kits 1–5: any confident colleague. You do not need to be a communications expert. What you must hold firmly are the two slides that never move: **slide 12** (the red line on public AI translation, and the careful separation between our rule and what the law actually says) and **slide 13** (the human-only list: safety, discipline, grief, and special-education news travel by voice). If the room pushes for efficiency there, the answer is warm and immovable.

The session at a glance

Segment	Minutes	What happens
The last-contact test	0:00–0:06	Silent audit (slide 2), then the asymmetry
Why this is not soft	0:06–0:14	Kraft & Rogers with its scope; the 54-hour week; the thesis; agenda
The two kinds of message	0:14–0:25	Generic versus specific; where the detail comes from; the hard message; the tone second read
The lines that hold	0:25–0:30	The red line; the human-only list; the privacy rule
Lab: your Friday ten minutes	0:30–0:50	Four families → draft the shape → the one true detail → the hard message
Making it stick	0:50–0:56	Share-out; honest limits; three commitments; the month ahead
First 48 hours & close	0:56–0:58	Action sheet + exit ticket

Core session is 58 minutes. For a 45-minute slot: keep the audit at full length, shorten your debrief on slide 3, fold slide 9 into your talk on slide 8, give lab step 1 two minutes, and take one share-out voice. Two things are never cut: the lab, and slides 12 and 13. The script marks every cut where it falls.

Your 15-minute prep checklist

- ☐ **Send the staff email** (2 min, two days ahead): "Bring a charged device. You will leave with four notes written to four real families and one hard message drafted. No prep needed; bring your roster in your head."
- ☐ **Take the last-contact test yourself** (2 min): pick your own difficult student and find the date. You cannot ask a room to sit in that silence if you have not.
- ☐ **Write your own four sentences** (5 min): four true, dated, specific things you saw this week, one per child. This is the step teachers stall on, and a facilitator who has done it coaches it much better.
- ☐ **Add a "Communication" section** to the staff prompt doc from Kit 2 (1 min).

- ☐ **Click through the deck** (3 min): confirm all 32 slides display, the Ms. Rivera tracker chip shows top-right, and slides 22, 23, and 25 (the finished notes and the hard message, word for word) are readable from the back of your room.
- ☐ **Print the handouts** (2 min): Participant Handout, First 48 Hours, Exit Ticket, one of each per person.

Room, tech & timing

Same setup as Kits 1–5: projector, Wi-Fi, pair seating, a visible clock. Timing discipline: the lab must start by 0:30. Cut discussion before you ever cut the lab. Protect all six minutes of lab step 3 (the one true detail); it is the step the whole session exists for, and it is the one that looks skippable when you are behind. Expect a quiet, slightly raw room after the audit. That is the session working, not a problem to fix.

Facilitator FAQ

"Isn't a batch of AI-drafted positive notes exactly the fake thing we should avoid?"

It would be, if the note were only what the tool wrote. The whole design prevents that: the prompt instructs the tool to leave a blank line in each note, and the teacher writes the one specific true sentence into it by hand. The tool supplies the container. The teacher supplies the proof that somebody was looking. The swap test settles any argument: put another child's name in the sentence, and if it still works, it was not a note yet.

"Can I just have AI write the difficult email? It's better at tone than I am at 9 p.m."

No, and give this a real answer rather than a rule. A message that carries consequences has to be defensible by the person who sent it, and the relationship with that family is what does the work, not the prose. What the tool gets is one narrow job: a second read for tone, after you have written it, with the prompt on slide 11 that explicitly forbids replacement wording. It reads it back. You write it.

"How careful do I have to be with the Kraft & Rogers number?"

Very. Say the scope out loud every single time the number leaves your mouth: it was a summer credit-recovery program, so those students were retaking a course they had already failed, and the study tested a bundle (individualized content, weekly frequency, improvement framing), so no single ingredient is proven to be the active one. Never say personalization is "the mechanism." If you drop the scope in this room, someone repeats the number without it to a board member next month.

"What about families who read limited English?"

Write the original in plain language: short sentences, no idioms, the action first. That is the version every family can use and the version district translators work best from. Official documents travel your district's translation channels; that is the district's obligation. Teachers do not run family messages through a public AI translator, because you cannot review what you cannot read. Keep our rule and the law separate when you say it: the 2015 ED/DOJ Dear Colleague Letter requires meaningful communication with limited-English-proficient parents and qualified review of machine translation for essential information; it does not itself forbid teacher use. Our rule is stricter because we chose it.

"What about our messaging platform's built-in AI?"

District-adopted platforms follow district policy and their own agreements; today is about public general-purpose tools and the habits that transfer. Park platform questions for leadership; do not endorse or criticize a product by name.

After the session: 5 minutes

- Collect exit tickets; they double as PD documentation.
- Read the "one true detail you are proudest of noticing" answers. Those are the material for follow-up #2, and they are also the best thing you will read that week.
- Note who left without a day on the calendar for their ten minutes. The habit dies without a day, and a kind nudge this week beats a cold check-in at the PLC.

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